

Breaking open

If you try to break open a standard smartwatch, it will split into approximately seven parts apart from the main casing and strap. These seven parts are:

- Antenna
- Battery
- Main board component
- Casing and charging connectors
- Waterproof seal
- Screen
- Vibration unit

for added navigation capabilities, and atmospheric pressure sensors for adventure seekers. Then, there are bio sensors that sense calorie consumption, blood pressure, ECG, EMG, temperature and brain waves to measure activity patterns.

Processing nerve centre. This consumes very little space and power. There are many players in this arena such as ARM and MediaTek that provide chipsets. A processor with quad-core architecture shelling out 1.2GHz is powering today's smartwatches.

Wireless chipset. Data transmission is done using NFC, Bluetooth and Wi-Fi connectivity. Watches need to remain on and active so that these could be synchronised to get the most accurate information.

Screen. The only way to interact with a smartwatch is through its screen. A watch also takes voice commands but may need the connected phone around. Smartwatch screens have the display and the capacitive touch panel layered onto each other. For now, four types of screens are used in smartwatches: liquid crystal display (LCD), sharp-memory LCD, E-ink and OLED. E-ink and LED screens are preferred more as these consume less power.

Battery types and wireless charging. Lithium-ion and lithium-polymer are the most preferred battery types. Life of these batter-

ies is around two years.

Wireless charging is also coming around, but it does not guarantee battery life. These are designed for convenience but the story ends there.

Popular recommendations for you

The all-rounder Moto 360 (2nd generation). With an improved processor and an impressive screen and visual quality, this watch gives you about 48-hour battery life. The watch comes with a wireless charging dock.

The incomparable smartwatch from Apple. In its latest instalment, Apple is seen moving towards fitness, and with its second-generation smartwatch and iPhone, it is segmenting itself to a specific range of customers who are adventurers. Better software, hardware and design perfection is making it a smartwatch that everyone would want their hands on.

Thinner and light-on-pocket LG Watch Style. This watch weighs just 46 grams. It does not have tons of non-useful features. The watch works on Android Wear 2.0 and packs a good punch with Snapdragon processor, more than one day of battery backup and 4GB of internal storage.

The performance watch, Sony smartwatch 3. It looks like a regular watch but packs in a quad-core 1.2GHz processor that makes it a great performer—better than its predecessor. It doubles up as a GPS and a fitness tracker, and is weather- and waterproof.

Tickle and activate Ticwatch. Compatible with iOS and Android, Ticwatch is available at half the price of most other smartwatches available today. The watch can be tickle-started with a swipe on the bezel of the watch once you unbox it. It has a mic and a speaker for you to receive calls in case there is no phone nearby. **EPY**

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